How to *win* the hackathon

Every team gets the same brief and clock. Foldo does the building. This page covers the rest.



THE RULES

1

Build for the judges, not the brief.

The rubric picks the winner. Show every line:

REAL-WORLD IMPACT
Who it helps, and by how much.

ORIGINALITY
Say what is new in one sentence.

EXECUTION & CRAFT
One polished flow. No dead buttons.

TRUST & RESPONSIBILITY
Say what is mocked and what you store.

2

Build something that has only just become possible.

Why couldn't this exist two years ago? Show the AI doing the work, live:

PAYMENTS
Snap an invoice, get a payment link.

ACCESS TO FINANCE
A loan offer explained in plain words.

FRAUD & SECURITY
Paste a text, see why it is a scam.

3

One person, one problem, one wow moment.

PAYMENTS
A trader waiting days for a payout.

ACCESS TO FINANCE
A renter with no credit file.

FRAUD & SECURITY
A parent about to pay a fake invoice.

Pick one. Protect the moment their problem disappears.

4

Build the demo path first.

Start from your track's template. Your first prompt is the screen judges will see. Messages are capped daily per team, so spend them there.

5

Put a number on screen.

"Flagged in 0.4 seconds" outlasts any adjective. Use real-looking names and amounts, and say what is mocked.

6

Freeze early. Keep a backup video.

Judges open your shared link, so rehearse on it from another laptop. Most phones can't run Foldo apps. Record a clean run in case the wifi fails.

The 2-minute demo

0:00	"Meet *[name]*. *[Their problem, with a number]*."
0:15	"Until now, *[why it couldn't be done]*. Now *[what changed]*."
0:30	One flow, live. Wow moment by 1:20. Narrate what they can't see.
1:30	"Real: *[this]*. Mocked: *[that]*. Under the hood: *[how]*."
1:45	"*[Who]* pays, because *[why]*. Next: *[one step]*." Stop. Leave the link up.

> *"Judges remember numbers."*
>
> FOLDO FIELD NOTES

DON'T

- × Open with the team or the slides.
- × Show the code.

THE TIMELINE

START
Read the rubric and judges' bios. Pick a track, a person, a wow moment.

FIRST HOUR
Prompt the demo screen with sample data. Fix what breaks before adding anything.

HALFWAY
Watch an outsider use the link unaided. Imagine you lost, and fix the reason.

FINAL HOUR
Feature freeze. Write the script, record the backup, rehearse twice, timed.

30 MINUTES BEFORE JUDGING
Hands off. List it in the gallery. Open the link on the demo laptop.